Kelly Vohs

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Operator and CEO. 29 years of leadership across hospitality, multifamily real estate, technology, and the U.S. military. Former Green Beret with four combat deployments. Spent 12 years leading Blackstone portfolio companies –building teams, scaling guest-centered cultures across distributed assets, and making capital allocation decisions at scale. Have led organizations from a single property to 175,000 residential units and $4B in revenue. Every role has come from a relationship. I want to do things that matter with people that matter to me.

EXPERIENCE

CEO, SafetyCulture 2025–2026

Global SaaS platform for frontline operations. Software for the workforce, not the deskforce. I'd been a customer since 2012. 25,000 customers in 180+ countries, including IKEA, Royal Caribbean, Toyota, and SpaceX. $215M ARR. Inherited a platform that needed a full rebuild and a team spread across Sydney, Manila, Manchester, Amsterdam, and Kansas City. Spent the first year on the road –250,000 miles –listening, learning, building the executive team, and resetting the product and go-to-market strategy. Relentless focus on building a culture of seeking, speaking, and acting on the truth.

CEO, LivCor (Blackstone) 2020–2025

Blackstone's national multifamily platform. Asked to take this on in August 2020 while still running Beam Living. Ran both companies simultaneously through COVID, then brought them together with LivCor as the parent platform. Grew from 40,000 to 175,000 apartments. $4B in revenue. Acquired Preferred Apartment Communities and hired CEOs for both Beam and PAC underneath. The central question was what belongs at the center and what belongs at the property level. Built a model that balanced shared capabilities with local autonomy across hundreds of communities. Created the "Good Neighbors" operating culture: kind, helpful, thoughtful, respectful. Zero evictions during COVID for two years. These are people's homes.

COO → CEO, Beam Living (Blackstone) 2017–2022

StuyTown – the largest rental community in the country. 11,241 apartments. A city within a city. Transformed it into Beam Living and grew the platform to 15,000 apartments across New York. $600M revenue. Built deep community relationships and resident-first operations in a place where 25,000 people call home. During COVID, built a community pantry, raised money, and delivered over one million pounds of food to New Yorkers in need.

General Manager, Hilton Hotels (Blackstone) 2013–2017

Boca Raton Resort & Club: two hotels, 1,047 rooms, two golf courses, 14 restaurants, 200,000 sq ft of meeting space, and a membership program. Complex, multi-dimensional hospitality. $30M improvement in EBITDA in three years. Relocated to Chicago to build and open the Conrad – adaptive reuse, first employee, grew the team to 250. Also ran the Waldorf Astoria Chicago. This is where Better Today Than Yesterday was born.

VP Operations, BR Guest Hospitality (Starwood) 2011–2013

Starwood portfolio company. 22 restaurants across six brands and 3,000 employees in New York City. First role after eight years in the army.

U.S. Army – Green Beret 2003–2011

Enlisted at 26, two weeks after the invasion of Iraq. Special Forces pipeline (18X), specializing in unconventional warfare. Learned Arabic. Earned the Green Beret after two years of selection and training. Specialized in human intelligence. Reached Sergeant First Class in under eight years. Four deployments to Iraq and Central Asia. Worked alongside CIA, State Department, and embassy teams in Baghdad, Kurdistan, Tajikistan, and Afghanistan. Earned an MBA (University of Colorado) while deployed.

The Breakers of Palm Beach 1996–2003

Walked in as a server at 18. Earned a degree in accounting while working full-time, finishing second in class. Built L'Escalier restaurant from the ground up and won the AAA Five Diamond Award. Left as Rooms Division Manager. Almost fired twice for putting process before people. That's where it started to change.

WHAT I'VE LEARNED ABOUT BUILDING TEAMS

At LivCor we ran hundreds of distributed communities, each with its own culture, team, and identity. My job was never to have all the answers. It was to build the right team, get the right people in the room, and then move together with speed and conviction. That's how I try to lead. Rarely perfectly, but always trying to get better. Build the team. Clarity, alignment, resources, emotional connectedness. Best idea wins. Teams win.

I think we proved that you can do well and do good at the same time.

HOW I LEAD

I believe in an order of operations: people, product, performance. Get a great team, you'll have a great product. Have a great product, you'll get great performance. That sequence matters.

I learned early – at The Breakers, then in the army – that it's *we*, not *me*. Build the team. Give them expectations, process, voice, and care. You'll find that team has superpowers. I still believe that.

At the Boca Raton Resort, 39 days in, I was sitting on my office floor staring at 67 projects on a whiteboard. There was no way we could do all of it. Then I said out loud: *do what you can every day.* If we get 1% better each day, it compounds. That became Better Today Than Yesterday. That's how I try to run everything now. I write about it weekly here.

I believe in leadership by working around, not management by walking around. You have to actually do the thing.

PERSONAL

Married to Brandi. Three sons – 21, 19, 15. Based in New York City. Willing to relocate. Brandi and I have built our life around the next adventure.

I take photos, write about getting better, and make software. I'm old enough to know that what 80-year-old me will care about is the mission and the people I did it with. At home and at work.

People aren't resumes. They aren't titles. They're just people trying to do their best. Hopes, dreams, strengths, struggles. When you find the right dance partners, that's when the good work happens. This is a bit about me, but not everything. Not what I'm most proud of. Not all the mistakes and lessons. But hopefully it's helpful.

– Kelly

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